

PLAYER MANUAL

Version 1.7.2 · English

Free to play · Open source · MIT

PHENIX REBIRTH

1. Overview

Phenix Rebirth is a modern PC remake of the arcade shoot'em up Phoenix (1978 / 1980). It keeps the stage cycle, the boss saucer and the fast pace of the original, with modern graphics, the PHENIX mode, a second ship (the Shield), gamepad and keyboard, and 13 languages.

Two ways to play: the **arcade game** (solo, hot seat taking turns, or simultaneous coop), and the **Adventure**, a story mode in three acts with its mission map, hangar, workshop, Bestiary and illustrated scenes.

Unofficial fan project. This is not an official port by Amstar Electronics, Centuri or Taito.

2. Installation

Windows (simple): download the Windows build (zip) from GitHub or itch.io, unzip it and start the game. From the sources, double-click lancer.bat: it installs Pygame if needed, then launches the game.

Requirements (sources): Python 3.10+, Pygame 2.5+ and imageio-ffmpeg (for the videos of the scenes).

Command line:

```
git clone https://github.com/Kraran/PhenixRebirth.git
cd PhenixRebirth
python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
python main.py
```

Optional Windows build: build_exe.bat (PyInstaller).

Downloads: github.com/Kraran/PhenixRebirth/releases/tag/v1.7.2 · kraran.itch.io/phenix-rebirth

3. Main menu

PLAY opens the ARCADE GAME screen: the mode (1 player, 2P Hot Seat, 2P Co-op), the difficulty, then the ship select. **ADVENTURE** opens the story mode. **EXTRAS** gathers High Scores, Achievements, Jukebox, Credits, Help and Add-On. **OPTIONS** and **QUIT** complete the menu.

In a game, Esc / Start opens the pause: RESUME, OPTIONS, HELP / CONTROLS and QUIT RUN (ABANDON MISSION in the Adventure, after a confirmation).

4. Game modes and difficulties

- **1 player:** one pilot.
- **Hot seat:** two players take turns; each one plays a game, the best score wins.
- **Coop:** two ships on screen at the same time, 5 shared lives, separate scores and gauges. Player 2 is tinted blue when both pilots picked the same ship.

Difficulty	Rules
Novice	5 lives, slower enemies, the Phenix gauge never drops to zero. No high score.
Normal	3 lives, the arcade speed.
Veteran	3 lives, faster enemies, +10 points per enemy and the Commander at 1000.

5. Controls

These are the defaults. In *Options* > *Game* > *Keys and buttons* every key (two per action, on two keyboards) and every gamepad button can be changed. In solo the last device used flies the ship; in coop each player is given a keyboard half or a gamepad.

Action	Keyboard 2 (solo / coop P2)	Keyboard 1 (coop P1)	Gamepad
Move	Arrow keys	Q or A, D (Z or W, S)	Stick / D-pad
Fire	Space / Right Ctrl	Left Ctrl	A (or X, Y, RB)
PHENIX mode / Shield bubble	Right Shift	Left Shift	B
Antimatter missile (once unlocked)	M	E	LB
Pause	Esc	Esc	Start
Menus	Arrows + Enter	same	Stick / D-pad + A · B = back

One player shot on screen at a time (the Phoenix rule); dual flame shots in PHENIX form. Up and down only matter in a game with the two-dimensional impulse reactor, and in the free-flight missions of the Adventure (see section 10).

6. Stages and scores

Stage	Enemies	Points (Normal, levels 1 to 5)
1	Scout Avioids (dark birds)	10
2	Khaki Avioids	20
3	Gargoyles	30 (body only)
4	Dark Gargoyles	40
5	The Avioid commander's saucer + escorts	Core 500 · bricks 1 · decorations 50

- After the boss the cycle starts again, faster. From level 6 every enemy, the boss core and the saucer decorations are worth **+10 points in levels 6 to 10, +20 in levels 11 to 15**, and so on. Bricks stay at 1.
- Veteran: enemies +10, Avioid commander 1000.
- Bonus lives at **1337** and **8086** points.
- Gargoyles: hitting the wings is neutral; only the body kills and scores.
- Boss saucer (levels 5, 10, 15...): destroying both of its dishes halves the speed of its descent.

7. PHENIX mode and the Shield ship

The Phenix

Each body hit: +1 to the gauge. Each miss: -1 (wings, bricks and decorations are neutral). From 3, Shift or button B activates the form: you become a firebird, invulnerable, faster, with dual flame shots. The gauge drains as the timer. Press B / Shift again to cancel and keep the rest of the gauge. Short cooldown before you can activate again. Touching the electric walls of the edges ends the PHENIX form; outside the form, it empties the gauge.

The Shield

No Phenix form: a shield bubble instead. Full gauge = ready. B / Shift gives 2 s of invulnerability under a dome; the ship is locked in place, engines off. The bar drains while the shield is up, then refills over a 5 s cooldown.

The ship is chosen at the start of each arcade game (and for player 2 in hot seat and coop).

8. The Adventure

The Adventure starts from ADVENTURE in the main menu. It opens with an illustrated introduction read aloud (in French), then the mission map.

- **4 save slots**, each with the pilot's name, the act, the date and the mode.
- **Three modes:** *Novice* (3 lives to start, a 4th in the workshop; a failure gains nothing and costs 2% of your points), *Normal* (a failure: back to the workshop, no gain and 5% of your points lost), *Veteran* (quantum anchor unfinished: if you fall, it is for good).
- **Five tabs:** EXTRAS (Achievements, Jukebox, Credits, Options), BESTIARY (the files of the enemies met), LOG (the journal and the scenes to watch again), HANGAR (the ship, the workshop) and MAP (the missions).
- **Credits:** the points of a mission won become credits, spent in the workshop (speed, lives, dome, resistance to the electric walls, the Phenix gauge, paint, escort modules, antimatter missiles...). The workshop holds at most 99 999.
- **The map** marks the next mission and what opens a locked one ("Opens after: ..."). A mission marked "Once only" cannot be flown again before the end of the Adventure.
- **Scenes:** pictures, short looping videos, items to catch, and a visual novel with Lyra Voss between some missions.

Act 1: the Shield

Mission	Opens...
Bestiary I: First sortie	from the start
Bestiary II to IV	each one after the one before
Asteroid belt I (60 asteroids)	after Bestiary I
EDF - Silent Sentinels I: Jupiter	after Bestiary I
Dome I to V	Dome I after Asteroid belt I, then each one after the one before
Landing on Deimos · Raid I: Deimos	after Dome II
Landing on an asteroid · Raid II	after Dome IV
Defence of Phobos I: the horde (with Sacha)	after Dome V
Gateway to Act 2	after Defence of Phobos I

Act 2: the Phenix

Mission	Opens...
Asteroid belt II (80 asteroids)	from the start of Act 2
Guardians I: the first fire	after Asteroid belt II
Phenix I to V	Phenix I after Guardians I, then each one after the one before (Phenix III after Defence of Phobos II)
Defence of Phobos II: the siege (with Sacha)	after Phenix II
Landing on Europa · Raid III	after Phenix I
Landing on Titan · Raid IV	after Phenix III
Bestiary V: the Avioid commander	from the start of Act 2
Bestiary VI: the Guardians	after Phenix III
Paint I to III (optional)	from the start of Act 2, in order
Silent Sentinels II and III	each one after the one before
Guardians II: the wall of lasers	after Phenix V
Gateway to Act 3: the great raid	after Guardians II

Act 3: the Counterstrike

Mission	Opens...
Repairs (series)	from the start of Act 3, in order
Landing on Triton · Raid V	from the start of Act 3
Silent Sentinels IV: Neptune	after III
Asteroid belt III (100 asteroids)	once the repairs are done
Guardians III: the Alpha Guardian	after Asteroid belt III
Defence of Phobos III: the tide (with Sacha)	after Guardians III
Counterstrike I to V (Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune, Triton)	Counterstrike I after Defence of Phobos III, then each one after the one before

BONUS missions show up along the way. After Counterstrike V, one last mission closes the Adventure; then every mission can be flown again and the FINAL BONUS missions open (section 11).

9. The series of the Adventure

- **Bestiary:** each file opens when the enemy is met. The Bestiary hunts are replayable, one level harder after each win.
- **Dome, Phenix, Counterstrike:** the main series, arcade waves faster and faster, each one once only.
- **Defence of Phobos I to III:** one compulsory mission per act. The swarm rushes at Phobos in 4 waves (at level 11, then 16, then 21), each wave adding a kind: blue birds, khaki birds, gargoyles, dark gargoyles; 3 Guardians in the last wave of II and III. **Sacha**, a young pilot of Phobos, comes as reinforcement in his old EDF-17 C, flown by the computer, a little better from one mission to the next. He cannot die: after three hits (or a collision) he goes back to Phobos and you carry on alone. His points are his own.
- **Guardians:** their laser goes through the dome and burns the birds. The plumage of the Alpha Guardian gives the reflective coating.
- **Paint I to III:** a grid of enemies marches down on you, Space Invaders style; the saucer is worth 500 to 1000 PTS, aim for the middle. All three missions open the paint shop. The whole series can be flown again, harder.

- **Escort modules:** two gyroscope satellites that fly beside the ship and fire with it (shots ×2, then ×3). Their pieces are found in the landings and the raids; they are assembled in the workshop, take the hits meant for the ship and, destroyed, are bought again at half price.

10. Free-flight missions

In these missions the ship turns and thrusts: **left / right to turn, up to thrust**, fire to shoot.

Asteroid belt I to III

The prelude of the main series of each act, in the spirit of Atari's Asteroids. Open the road: destroy 60, 80 then 100 asteroids (every piece counts), then clear the screen. A saucer crosses now and then and fires at you. Replayable.

Landings (Lunar Lander)

Optional. Set the ship down gently on a flat zone: gravity pulls, momentum stays, and every second of thrust burns fuel. The smaller the zone, the bigger the bonus (×1, ×2, ×5). A perfect landing (upright and slow) pays 500 points + 50 per unit of fuel left, a rough one 100 + 10; a crash costs what a failure costs.

Landing	Opens in	Fuel
Deimos (low gravity)	Act 1	90
An asteroid of the belt	Act 1	80
Europa	Act 2	70
Titan (the strongest gravity)	Act 2	70
Triton	Act 3	60

Raids on the Avioid bases I to V (Scramble)

Optional. A side-scrolling shoot'em up in the way of Konami's Scramble: fly between the ceiling and the ground (the ship moves freely and fires to the right), dodge or destroy the missile stations, the birds and the comets, then shoot down the red Avioid commander of the base. From the first raid, the gentlest, to the fifth, the full Scramble. Touching the rock costs a life. The dome and the PHENIX form work there.

EDF - Operation Silent Sentinels I to IV (Space War)

Place a stealth spy satellite in orbit around each gas giant: Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus, Neptune. The planet in the middle pulls the ship (not the torpedoes), momentum is total and the screen wraps on its four sides. Plasma is useless: 20 antimatter torpedoes, 1 life, 2 or 3 levels. The rings of Saturn are harmless. Each mission is flown once until IV is won; then all four can be played again.

The antimatter missile

Winning Silent Sentinels IV unlocks the antimatter missile. The workshop sells the launcher (permanent) and the missiles (consumable: a missile that is not fired stays for the next mission). One missile per mission, fired straight ahead (M / E / LB): it destroys every enemy within a quarter of the screen of its impact (on the armour of the saucer: two bricks round the impact) and is lost if it touches nothing.

11. FINAL BONUS

Once the game is finished, six endless missions open at the end of Act IV, under END BONUS. Each one ends with the GAME OVER: its points pay in credits, without a penalty, and the record is kept at the top of the screen. **Leaving a run (from the pause) gains nothing.**

- **FINAL BONUS - Scramble:** endless Scramble. Fly through the rock to the base and shoot down the red commander, then go again with more enemies, until your last life. You choose the setting at the start. One record for all the settings.

- **FINAL BONUS - Lunar Lander:** to the last drop, 90 units at the start. After each landing, fly again with the fuel left (+50 for a perfect landing, +25 for a rough one), over a ground where the big zones get rarer and rarer. The run ends with a crash or an empty tank. You choose the setting at the start; one record per setting.
- **FINAL BONUS - Asteroids:** level after level (4, 6, 8, 10 then 11 big asteroids, all there from the start); the saucer fires 10 % faster each level and, every 5 levels, the saucers come by two. Until the ship is lost.
- **FINAL BONUS - Guardians:** the classic game, endless, with one more Guardian each level (five at most); at level 6 it starts again with one big Guardian more, at level 11 with two, and so on. Everything you have in the workshop flies with you.
- **FINAL BONUS - Swarm:** the last wave of Defence of Phobos II, without an end: the four kinds at level 16, which always come back, and three Guardians, then three more each time the last one falls. Five versions to choose from: alone; with Sacha flown by the computer (he comes back repaired after each retreat); two players (Sacha flown by player 2); Sacha alone (you fly his EDF-17 C, three hits and it is over); Sacha leads (your ship as his wingman, flown by the computer). At the GAME OVER, **10 % of the score** in credits (5 % of the two scores at two); one record per version.
- **FINAL BONUS - Space War:** see below.

FINAL BONUS - Space War

Endless Space War around the gas giant you choose at the start, with its gravity: **Jupiter, Saturn, Uranus or Neptune**.

Level	Opponents
1	1 blue bird
2	2 blue
3	2 blue and 1 green
4 and up	2 blue and 2 green
5, 10, 15...	+ a saucer

- **20 torpedoes**, renewed at each level. **One life.**
- **GAME OVER** when the ship is destroyed, or when you have no torpedo left while opponents remain. The points pay in credits either way.
- The workshop antimatter missile, if it is unlocked: **one per run**.
- **One record per planet.**

12. Options

Five tabs: GAME, GAMEPLAY, AUDIO, DISPLAY, ADVANCED (Tab / Page Up / Page Down on the keyboard, LB / RB on the gamepad). A help panel describes the option under the cursor. The settings are kept in settings.json.

- **Game:** Controls (Auto, keyboard or gamepad), Co-op 1 and Co-op 2 (the control of each player), Keys and buttons, Auto fire (On: hold fire to shoot again; Off: one press per shot), Rumble (0 to 5), Language (13 languages).
- **Gameplay:** the Play style of a solo arcade game, *Classic* or *Adventure*. The Adventure style gives some of the equipment of the Adventure, with no high score: Escort modules (shots ×3), Antimatter missiles (1 to 20, or none), 2D reactor (the ship also flies up and down, in the lower third of the screen) and **Guardians**: as in FINAL BONUS - Guardians, Guardians come with the birds on every level, the boss levels too, 1 to 5 of them, one more each level, then from level 6 one more Alpha Guardian every five levels (off by default). The game always starts in Classic; the choice does not count in hot seat or coop.
- **Audio:** SFX Volume, Music Volume, In-game audio (SFX only, SFX + theme, music only or mute; not saved), In-game music (none, a jukebox track, Lyra Voss's songs included, or your own mp3, wav, ogg... files put in the game's musique_perso folder).

- **Display:** window, fullscreen or borderless; Bezel for screens wider than 16:9 (Phoenix, Tesla, Blue Phenix, Flame Phenix, off; fullscreen only); CRT Scanlines (0 to 3); FPS Counter.
- **Advanced:** GPU render, VSync (On, Adaptive, Off), Refresh (60, 75, 120 or 144 frames per second; the game speed stays the same), Reset High Scores.

13. Extras

- **High Scores:** the 15 best scores, 3-letter initials, with the ship and the mode of each game (coop scores carry a two-player icon). Codes to type on this screen (they block the entry to the table): LV02 to LV99 (start at that stage), LIVE, PHEN.
- **Achievements:** two pages, ARCADE (32) and ADVENTURE (32), as illustrated cards; the metal of the frame is the tier (steel, bronze, silver, gold). Some stay secret until found.
- **Jukebox:** all the music of the game, the intro video, and the lyrics of the songs of Lyra Voss synced on her voice, translated in the 13 languages.
- **Credits**, **Help** (the story, the controls, the enemies, the Phenix and the Shield) and **Add-On** (the original arcade games, run with MAME: put mame.exe and the roms in addon\mame).

14. Credits

Development: Franck Fornasari (Kraran)

Beta testers: Cécile, Wallems, Luca and Sacha

Technical assistance and design: Grok — xAI · Claude — Anthropic

Inspiration: Phoenix (1980 - Taito) — Amstar Electronics / Centuri / Taito · Pleiades (1981 - Tehkan)

Music: the Phenix themes (Eternal Dawn, Last Coin, Nostalgie...) and the songs of Lyra Voss — created with Suno. Voice of the introduction: ElevenLabs.

Fonts: Audiowide and Play (SIL Open Font License 1.1), DejaVu Sans.

MIT License · github.com/Kraran/PhenixRebirth · kraran.itch.io/phenix-rebirth

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No quarter given. No continue forever.